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Go to the root cause, use the smallest possible force

In India, we have 130 fatalities per 100,000 vehicles per year. The comparable value for the UK is six fatalities per 100,000 vehicles per year. [1] We are *twenty-two times* worse.

The appropriate measure that should be used in this comparison is fatalities per kilometre, but this is not measured in India. Each vehicle in India probably travels fewer kilometres per year than is the case in the UK. In this case, road safety in India is *over* twenty-two times worse than in the UK.

Poor road safety has significant implications upon the health of the people. Would we treat the problem by building additional hospital capacity along highways?

Treat the disease, not the symptom

If a person has malaria, we do not attack the fever. The same idea holds with market failures. Market failures generate visible consequences. Practical men and women are often attracted to use the power of the state to reverse those visible consequences. But we should understand the anatomy of the market failure and address it at the root cause.

The right way to address the road safety problem is to go to the root cause, to the public goods of highway management. The lowest cost